She-Ra and the Princesses of Power - BOOK 3: Rulers of Etheria. ARC 2: Calderon Rising

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/43851517.

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Mature

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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Relationship:
Catra (She-Ra) & Original Male Character(s), Adora/Glimmer (She-Ra)

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Part 4 of SPOP: The Third Child

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by DozenthTurmoil

Summary

In the aftermath of The Crimson Wastes Campaign, the mysterious long thought dead kingdom of Calderon releases an invitation to both the Coalition and Ziadroth.

Is it a trap? Or something far more?

The war doesn't favour the cautious, so both sides are far too eager to find out...

Notes

Merry Christmas and happy holidays!

As a gift to all, i decided to release the first chapter ahead of the rest of Arc!
Don't worry the rest is on its way!

Chapter 1

ARC II

Calderon Rising

Chapter 6

The Child and The Call

The Great War's battles extend across Etheria, the lines have been drawn and blood has already been shed. Many Coalition soldiers battle Ziadrothan Warriors across countless warzones in every corner of the continent. Still, life manages to go on as the trees turn into various shades of red, amber and gold and the air grows colder, the onset of winter becomes more and more apparent to those who live in the Kingdom of Brightmoon, with its many towns and villages enjoying the peace that those who volunteer can provide them.

Adora sat down with her wife, enjoying a quiet day in the kingdom. The two were in the royal bedroom, sitting together on the edge of their bed having a peaceful moment together as the rays of the sun entered through the skylight, covering them with its warmth. Glimmer gently ran a thumb over the bullet scars that pocketed Adora's arm, the result of Gareth's shotgun and of the hyper-regeneration of She-ra which caused the wounds to heal over the embedded pellets and thus the pellets had to be surgically removed.

Adora didn't mind it too much, those scars are probably going to be gone the next time she goes into her She-Ra form. At least that's what Bow suggested. Glimmer smiled up at Adora and Adora looked back at her. "Any day now" Glimmer said softly as she pats her large tummy, Adora felt emotion well up in her eyes

as she looked at her. Glimmer looked beyond beautiful, she was absolutely radiant in her beauty and having her by her own side made Adora feel like she was on top of the world.

“Yeah, any day now. You feeling okay?” Adora asked Glimmer to which she nodded and leaned gently onto her shoulder a bit. “I guess I'm a fucking bit nervous, given the baby…” Glimmer rubbed her eyes a bit and looked over to the bedroom door. Adora kissed Glimmer’s cheek and chuckled “alright alright, i’ll get us some breakfast. You stay here” Adora said as she got up and walked out of the door and left Glimmer by herself

The cold that infused the very air across Brightmoon, with the trees having long since transformed into an amber blend of colors dispensing their leaves into the air as the wind grew more and more harsh. The cold bit into everyone and everything, but thanks to the mages of Mystacor and...Shadow Weaver, The castle has maintained a great heat that keeps things rather cozy. Adora still couldn’t believe that in any moment she could be a mother, being a queen was its own challenge...but she didn’t want to be like... *her* .

Adora leaned against a pillar to catch her breath from the sudden intrusion of stress, she shook her head and refocused. She caught a glimpse of shadows entering the kitchen...no doubt it was Shadow Weaver. Adora breathed in and out before entering the kitchen and seeing the cooks shift their attention to Adora, snapping off Brightmoon salutes.

Shadow Weaver turned her head towards Adora, the white eyes of her mask briefly widened before looking away. “Adora, I was just procuring some wine.” Shadow Weaver explained curtly and crossed her arms before staring off into a pile of dishes that still needed cleaning from the night before. Adora rolled her eyes before leaning forward onto the kitchen counter that separates her from the cooks working tirelessly in the kitchen.

“Hey, I would like the usual for me and Glimmer.” Adora said with a calm voice, it was a gentle voice...a voice at ease despite the

chaos she had to live through the invasion of the Crimson Wastes. The head chef itched the stubble on his blubbery chin and nodded. "Aye, we can get it for ye." The head chef then turned to his crew and yelled loudly, his small brown eyes flared up with emblazoned emotion. The kitchen staff turned their heads towards the head chef.

"Two ordahs! One egg beney-dict and bay-con! One egg batt'red toast and sausig!" yelled the head chef, and the staff yelled out confirmation. He then looked at Adora, the warrior queen of Brightmoon, and smiled with a mouth of old fractured teeth. "We'll be havin that up for ye both in about 5 minutes." he said, the end of his words ended with a gentle whistle of breath going through two chipped teeth. Adora nodded and smiled kindly "thanks Frank! I appreciate it" Adora said with a chipper attitude before she walked back into the main hall and towards the royal bedroom.

"So ehhh, ere's yer wine Miss Weaver" Frank stated placing a 6-pack of wine bottles in front of Shadow weaver to which she nodded and looked from side to side before sliding a handful of silver coins before holding the pack to her chest. "Feckin' 'ell woman, it ain't eellegal for ye to have dis." Frank said exasperated and with an eye roll to which Shadow Weaver simply dismissed Frank with a wave of her hand.

Shadow Weaver then made her way to the *quarters* that have been assigned to her. In truth, It was more of a repurposed storage room that had been converted into a bedroom, though Weaver preferred it significantly better than the damned cheese cellar she had to stay in for 2 weeks. Her clothes had to endure so many washes to be rid of the cheese stench.

Shadow Weaver was about to turn the door knob and embrace sweet isolation when Glimmer's piercing shriek echoed across the halls and made the sorceress' blood run icy cold. Almost immediately the guards began rushing towards the royal bedroom as if the entire kingdom was under siege. But Weaver knew that

this was no attack, especially when she heard Adora's panicked footsteps, enhanced by her being in the She-Ra form.

"GET THE FUCK OUT OF MY WAY!!!" Adora screamed, running with Glimmer screaming in pain with tears running down her cheeks. Bow had run out of his room just in time to see the queens run past him. The Archer and the Sorceress locked eyes for a brief moment, but it was all the time to tell each other what was coming.

Bow ran like hell but was surprised by how fast Adora was, it was easy to forget how fast she-ra could be, but in the way She-Ra ran like hell, Bow was glad that no one was in the hallways leading up to the midwifery chamber. By the time the young archer had reached the waiting room outside the midwifery chamber he saw Adora, his long time friend, sitting outside.

He stopped in his tracks and saw Adora sitting down, her gaze glued to the floor and she was notably not in her she-ra form. She looked up at Bow and had an expression of anxiety to which Bow approached her and sat next to her. "So uhhh...congrats in advance?" Bow said warmly and patted her back to which Adora nodded a bit.

"Just...a bit nervous. I hope the baby likes me and...well i can be a good mom and all. Just trying to balance being She-Ra, a Queen of Brightmoon AND a mom is going to be tough" Adora said with an exhale and leaning back on the chair. Bow chuckled and smiled "yeah you can handle that stuff, you're one strong person Adora!" Bow said with a happy grin to which Adora playfully punched his shoulder with a chuckle.

Eventually the soft cries of a baby echoed throughout the halls and the midwife exited the hallway and wiped her hands. She smiled at Adora who was looking right at her. "Would you like to meet your daughter?" The midwife said to which Adora nodded excitedly and walked right past her.

Glimmer looked like a wreck with frazzled hair and a tired expression which is to be expected. But her face brightened up when Adora walked inside. “Hey Babe…” Glimmer said tiredly to which Adora smiled awkwardly, sitting next to Glimmer but looking at the small bundle of pink cloth.

The child took a lot of appearance from Glimmer, that much was certain. But she inherited Adora’s eyes and blonde hair, even now after calming down a bit the child was looking at Adora with those beautiful eyes. “H-hey...i’m your mommy…” Adora asked with a happy smile.

“Soo...I was thinking of Traya?” Adora said looking at Glimmer who did a playful roll of her eyes. “Adora, that’s so fu-“ Glimmer’s eyes went as wide as boulders before looking at their child before clearing her throat “that’s just silly. But...its got a good ring to it...how about Kreia?” Glimmer mused, Adora nodded in agreement.

Across the continent of Uridex, past the whispering woods, past the coalition’s borders, the warzones and towards the industrial borders of Ziadroth. The immense walls of Ziadroth stand high, almost as tall as a mountain and past the equally impressive gates. The immense megacity that goes as deep as it goes tall lies ahead, with immense spires and neon lights. The rumbling of monorails rumbling through the city and the flight of patrol robots are common sights in this unrivaled wonder of technological prowess.

Castle Elinas remained tall, basking in the glow of its might city like the heart of a primordial god. Deep within the immense towering castle, Entrapta also known as The Royal Scientist and the Forge Mistress has her immense command center. Here she commands the immense factories of Ziadroth, the robotic legions and inventing new ways for Ziadroth to conduct its many functions.

Entrapta sipped a bit of Recaff, a caffeinated drink brewed from plants imported from the Crimson Wastes, and sat in her chair.

Observing the red glow of the terminal before her as Hordak sat next to her also looking at the terminal. His red eyes squinting as Entrapta took a gentle sip. “Well, it's certainly a signal. Not a distress Signal, but more of an invitation by the looks of it.” Hordak mused as he poured himself a cup of recaff.

“You are correct” Entrapta said, patting Hordak on the head with one hair tendril and readying up an audio log with the other. “Signal Log #3: Me and Hordak have fully decrypted the signal sent to us from the region of Calderon. I have requested the Emperor and Empress’ presence immediately to determine a course of action” Entrapta said to her recorder before turning it off. Now they waited until Gareth and Catra came down to discuss this interesting discovery.

There came a small mechanical shunt which drew Hordak’s attention to the door as Entrapta spun in her chair. Gareth rolled his neck and was wearing very basic clothing. The 6’4” man looked very tired and rubbing his right eye with the back of his fist, the faint glow of the godstone could be barely seen through his basic shirt.

Catra was wearing one of Gareth’s shirts which draped over her lean, muscular form like a shroud. She wore some basic slacks over her legs and some simple socks. Of course their red metal wedding bands were proudly displayed on their hands.

Indeed, one would think these were a passionate pair of married lovers and not one of the most powerful royal couples on the planet. Catra was pouting angrily with crossed arms while Gareth had a more calm but tired expression. “Mind telling me why you woke me and Garbear up at 3 in the morning?” Catra complained as Gareth looked at the red screen behind Hordak and Entrapta. which was displaying a list of text, translated to Ziadrothan of course.

“Well a signal was broadcasted from a region of Etheria that we had assumed was...well abandoned. Since the fall of the first princess alliance, this kingdom isolated itself, doing it so well that

we thought they simply died on islolation.” Entrapta explained before pushing herself aside on her office chair, the clattering of the wheels against the metal floors echoed in the room. Hordak typed on a nearby keyboard which brought up the source of the signal on a map of Uridex.

“The fire kingdom? Calderon?” Catra exclaimed with a raise of both of her eyebrows. Gareth recalled reading about it in the Fright Zone archives, Catra had also done the same. It made for good bedside reading from their personal data tablets, either way. Entrapta nodded and smiled “correct Catra! Calderon has sent a signal towards the entire continent. It's not a distress signal, but rather...an invitation.” Entrapta said with a smirk, the gleam of malevolent curiosity shone in her eyes.

“An invitation eh? I assume that’s the text?” Gareth said, extending a hand over to the red monitor to which Entrapta nodded as Hordak pulled up the text. Gareth stroked his chin as he examined it while Catra tilted her head as she read the text.

Hello Kingdoms. We are alive. We have survived, and now we wish to join a side. Please send diplomats, or your leaders (we aren’t picky), so that we can make an educated guess on how to re-enter the world on the right side. Hope to see you soon!

Best Regards,

Princess Flintecca

Gareth and Catra exchanged glances before Gareth stroked his chin again and leaned on the balls of his feet as he processed the information. “Hoooow exactly were they able to send a signal that we were able to pick up? We’re not exactly magically aligned, but its clear it’s meant to be heard by everyone.” Catra asked, trying to make sense of all of this information coming to her.

Hordak cleared his throat and looked at the Emperor and Empress. "It was sent using First Ones technology. Which indicates that not only do they have a significant stash of such items but they have enough to construct a communications array. Such a stash of technology can wildly alter the course of the war, if it falls to Coalition hands...then they could have a means of countering our current technology." Hordak explained, allowing his tone of voice to convey the severity and importance of this situation. He sighed and leaned back, about to open his mouth but Gareth spoke.

"We can't go in there guns blazing, they may have functioning weapons, which means we will gain some major losses in both warriors and resources. We'll have to use diplomacy...and we don't have...diplomats" Gareth said, his voice trailing off as the realization was falling onto himself and Catra.

"One of you would have to act as your diplomatic liaison ...and I think we all know would be better suited for the subtle acts of diplomacy and subterfuge" Entrapta mused playfully as Catra looked at everyone in the room. Catra slumped her shoulders and leaned forward with a groan, this was gonna be one hell of a challenge.

"You'll do great kit kat!" Gareth said, patting Catra's back and smiling happily. Catra hugged Gareth, gave him a kiss and purred happily. "I know i will! I'll miss you babe!" Catra said, giving Gareth a few more kisses to which Entrapta giggled and rolled her eyes.

"It's not like you're going to be gone by tomorrow! We need to prepare for the journey in the first place! So go rest up you two!" Entrapta laughed and held onto her sides a bit while Hordak rolled his eyes sarcastially.

Gareth and Catra exited the room casually with Catra lightly smacking Gareth's butt which caused him to jump a bit, the act enticed a series of giggles from Catra. Entrapta and Hordak exchanged glances before they placed some Tokens, the currency

of Ziadroth made out of recycled metal and embedded with the 4-horned goat skull sigil of Ziadroth, onto a table.

"Catra's not going to get pregnant, call it a safe bet love, but I doubt the 3,282,112th time will not result in pregnancy" Hordak said with confidence and placed 40 Tokens onto the table. Entrapta grinned from ear to ear and leaned back on her chair, which made an audible creak.

"Before Gareth left for the Crimson Wastes Campaign, Catra and him had a 3 hour sex session. When he came back they had a 2 hour sex session. But this will be Catra's first field mission in 3 years, she's going to miss Gareth...a lot. But more than that, she confided in me just this morning that she now wants an heir with their kingdom all made and after a victorious campaign." Entrapta explained, every detail she got closer and closer to Hordak with every single word.

Hordak began to realize what was about to happen, his red eyes widened as Entrapta explained further. "Catra and Gareth are going to not only have their longest sex session because Catra's not going to have one for an unknown amount of time but more than that, she's going to actually try to get pregnant this time, I predict that she will succeed with a legendary...7 hours of sex." Entrapta said, her eyes with pure fascination.

"Wait are...are they even genetically compatible? Gareth's a cocktail of human, Eternian and something else. Catra's a thunderian...two very different species." Hordak stammered as he tried to process everything that Entrapta was saying. "I ran their DNA samples through various simulations...guess what? They are! It's just that they need an overabundance of semination...and Catra will receive that!" Entrapta said and, without breaking eye contact with her lover, slid a whopping 140 tokens across the table to the pile.

"Did...you find anything else about Gareth's DNA?" Hordak asked to which Entrapta leaned back and tapped her chin. "Its no secret that we all know Weaver fused Gareth with the Godstone of

Apophis. The portal incident confirmed that for everyone. But the two have been fused for so long, the Godstone has been permanently fused to his ribcage but more than that, the apparent myth that Godstones are made from the blood of the God Serpents' former physical forms has been proven." Entrapta explained, a tendril of her hair pressing a button revealing a comparison chart revealing Gareth's DNA when he was 5 and as of this morning.

Hordak gazed upon the new composite strain that made up 1% of Gareth's DNA, a golden and divine-esque strain that was steeped in raw power. His jaw dropped at this revelation.

"I predict a 98% chance that this divinity will not afflict their future child, but I can confirm that the child will be a Thunderian, not human...apparently just how Thunderian genetics work. But other traits will be present from Gareth." Entrapta poured herself a cup of Ziadrothan soda and looked outside towards the window overlooking the massive forge.

"Make way for the Prince" Entrapta said with a smirk

Chapter 7: Diplomatic Deployment

The rumbling of the Landboat, a far smaller and swifter variant of the mighty Ziadrothan Landship, did little to alleviate the feeling of sickness afflicting her body. Catra gripped onto both sides of the cabin sink to try and steady herself against the rumbling and her nausea. She looked tiredly into the mirror, despite the sickness, her eyes were filled with joy as she looked at herself with a weak smile and gently placed a hand over her stomach. Entrapta told her about the symptoms she should be looking for and gave her a little tester to confirm it, everything pointed to her carrying her own child and it filled her with resolve stronger than titanium.

Catra took a deep breath and exited the Cabin bathroom, sitting on the command Cabin's left bed was her closest friend…Scorpia. Scorpia looked concerned but also relieved at the same time. "So uhhh…feeling fine?" Scorpia said with a sheepish smile to which Catra nodded and grabbed her horned crown from the nightstand next to the bathroom door and placed it on.

"Yeah, sucks that it kicked in the day after we left though…" Catra muttered, she really wanted to tell Gareth but they were out of comms range by the time the Empress was able to confirm it. Scorpia shrugged and smiled "hey! Nothing to worry about at all!" Scorpia said and offered Catra a gentle hug to which Catra smiled and giggled. "Besiiiides we're on a diplomacy mission! I doubt there's going to be any violence" Scorpia said, trying to ease Catra's worries. Which, to Scorpia's credit, were working. "Also! You got Kyle, Lonnie and Rogelio here with us! We got your back Wildcat!" Scorpia said, pointing to the covered window. Catra nodded and tiredly rubbed her eyes a bit before Scorpia helped her sit down and patted her head.

Catra's mind wandered about what this child is like, there were many things going through her head. The child had only just been conceived but she can already tell it was a son, she couldn't describe it, but she just knew. Perhaps it was just mother's intuition? She couldn't truly tell though, it was weird. Despite this, she felt happy that she was a mother, in fact overjoyed. Catra knew deep down that she would treasure her child, she promised herself right then that she would try to be the best mother for her son…she would not be like Weaver.

Catra rolled her neck and hugged Scorpia "thanks for helping me out Scorpia" she said gently to which Scorpia gave her own gentle hug to Catra, making sure not to crush her. "No problem at all Wildcat"

Elsewhere on the landboat, Kyle was leaning against the railing of the rear section of the landboat, watching the land roll by them as his dirty blonde hair flowed with the wind. The engine of the landboat was rumbling viciously with the ground it was ripping across, taking a specific path that was nowhere close to any of the brutally contested warzones.

Kyle exhaled softly and continued idly watching the rocks get dislodged by the spiked wheels of the vehicle. Lonnie and Rogelio approached the area where Kyle was. "I guess he's already homesick?" Lonnie asked, looking up to Rogelio with crossed arms to which Rogelio growled in confirmation. Kyle looked up and caught the sight of Lonnie, he stood up and smiled happily. "Hey guys!" The young man said with a blush dusting his cheeks.

“What’s gotten you down?” Lonnie said leaning next to a storage container on the Landboat while Rogelio maintained his stance. Kyle exhaled and stopped leaning on the rails, he adjusted his sniper rifle in its back holster before he spoke. “Well, this whole kid business...is it wise that Catra’s still coming with us? The Troops and us are going to have to ensure her safety at all times” Kyle spoke plainly but from a place of familial concern.

“Eh, that’s what we do Kyle. We’re the *Blackshields* . The claws of the emperor and empress.” Lonnie said with a shrug, her crimson armor sporting a completely black arm. The same armor patterns that she shared with Rogelio and Kyle. Kyle crossed his arms over his chest as the winds fluttered through his hair.

Rogelio let out a string of grunts and snarls. Lonnie and Kyle looked at each and nodded. “you’re right Rogelio, this isn’t the Crimson Campaign. It's doubtful that the Coalition will send an army either, especially the ass kicking we gave them. But Adora and Gareth had the luxury of fighting each other…” Kyle said, his voice trailing off when the Blackshields came to a realization that it's more than likely that Catra and Adora were going to be in the same room together attempting diplomacy…

Elsewhere, in Brightmoon, Adora was preparing for this mission of *diplomacy* . Though she was expecting a fight, she was not willing to bring an army into this. They had already lost enough people during the Crimson campaign, Adora was not going to risk anymore lives. She was packing up in Swift Wind’s private stable, ensuring that the saddle bags were at sufficient capacity with what she needed.

“Soo uhh, how’s being a mother treating you?” Swift Wind asked with a tilt of his head, not willing to endure another second of silent contemplation. Adora clicked her tongue slightly as she zipped up the last bag “well, it's…different. The baby sure can cry a lot but I love seeing her, Kreia’s just a wonderful little thing. I don’t like having to go away but we both know that Ziadroth isn’t going to back down from something like this.” Adora explained before looking over at Swift Wind, it was evident that she had not been sleeping well. She rubbed her eye a bit as she slung the saddle over her shoulder ready to put it on.

Suddenly the doors to the stable were kicked open and Adora, on pure instinct alone, drew her sword and aimed it at the doorway. Her eyes shook and her heart beated quickly only for her to see Frosta standing in the doorway, trying not to laugh. Adora let her shoulders lower and she pinched the bridge of her nose.

“Of all the-...you scared the shit out of me Frosta!” Adora exasperated, letting the sword tap against the floor as she loosely held it in her hand, she then placed her sword back into its armband form. Frosta calmed herself down “sorry about that, I couldn’t resist!” the ice princess said with a cocky smile.

“Did Glimmer approve of you coming onto the mission?” Adora asked while crossing her arms across her chest. Frosta nodded and smiled “she said i’d be vital to this mission” Frosta said as Adora placed the saddle on Swift Wind. It took Adora a couple of seconds to form a theory as to why Glimmer would think this, so she turned to look at Frosta and it clicked. *Fire and Ice.*

“Your ancestors were involved with Calderon weren’t they?” Adora said with a hint of awe in her voice. Frosta shook her head “well, not exactly…” Frosta’s voice began to take on her serious mode,

the same emotional state that she had during the Princess Prom all those years ago. There hasn't been one since the Horde wrecked the place.

"My parents were involved with Calderon, in fact they were part of the princess alliance. I owe it to my parents and to my kingdom to try and re-open ties to the kingdom." Frosta explained, becoming more professional in mannerism and voice with every single word she spoke.

"Calderon was originally under the control of Queen Volcana and King Ignis, they were both prominent members of the Princess Alliance. Though, their culture was extremely warrior-like compared to the rest of us. Ironic considering that's exactly the kind of people Ziadroth is known for, but anyways…The same ambush that saw many members of the Princess Alliance die also claimed Queen Volcana. She was very much loved by the people of Calderon, and even more loved by her husband. King Ignis cut Calderon off from the world, Princess Flintecca was a kid back then. My parents, Queen Angella and King Anore were the only survivors." Frosta explained in a monotone voice and a dead serious expression. Adora took this all in, she remembered King Anore, Spinnerella's father and the king of Amarand. Anore was present during Adora and Glimmer's wedding, Adora always remembered how much Spinnerella looked like her own father.

"My Parents disappeared, Angella's…gone thanks to that damn Snake and well…Anore's not holding out too well mentally according to Spinnerella." Frosta's voice trailed off before she shook her head. "I owe it to all of us to at least *try* to get Flintecca on our side. Even more so when we consider that Calderon and Ziadroth are both military-like cultures." Frosta explained, Adora grinded her teeth a bit at the thought. Ziadroth

had access to one runestone already, it would be devastating if they had *two* but worse than that. Calderon was smack dab in the heart of Mount Candila which was so close to their own territory. Ziadroth would have access to the heart of the Coalition at any time, forcing the Coalition to fight on two fronts, something Adora *knew* they couldn't do.

"Alright Frosta, hop on" Adora said looking over at Swift Wind who simply rolled his eyes teasingly. Frosta adjusted her backpack which only just now Adora noticed she had on, she got on to Swift wind shortly before Adora hopped on as well. "Alright Swifty! Lead the way!" Adora declared like the captain of a ship about to depart from the dock.

Swift Wind nodded and flew out of the stable and into the air, Frosta held onto Adora just a bit tightly, something Adora noticed. Adora forgot that not everyone is used to riding a flying horse and reaching speeds and heights that rivaled horde aircraft. "Just hold on and enjoy the ride okay?" Adora said with a smile to which Frosta quietly nodded, trying not to look down at the rolling landscape beneath them.

"How are you so used to this? I don't think I'd ever get used to being so high up in the sky!" Frosta said, being just audible enough to be heard over the wind. Adora smiled gently to herself and looked up into the skies even further above her head. "I love the sky, the wind blowing through my hair and the sights." the blonde said as the winds blew past them.

"Care to elaborate?" Frosta asked, trying to use the conversation as a distraction from the heights below them. Adora's gentle smile stayed as she, indeed, elaborate. "Growing up, I didn't have

much. Lonnie, Rogelio, Kyle…Gareth and Catra were all I had. All I knew was the electric lights, the steel ceilings. It felt restricting, I felt…trapped at times, as if the walls were going to strangle me. But in my dreams? weeeell…I always dreamed of flying, to see everything without having to ever use my legs." Adora mused out loud, extending a hand to a cloud that was just out of reach.

"Ever since I became She-Ra, ever since I joined the Rebellion and gotten Swifty? I have been living the dream I always wanted. In fact, my first date with Glimmer had us flying through the air on Swifty and seeing all the sights of Brightmoon." Adora petted Swift wind, who was focused on flying, but offered a smile.

"Well, where would you be without me huh?" Swift Wind said with a chuckle. Adora rolled her eyes and patted Swift Wind's neck a couple times as they flew. The rest of their flight over to Calderon was uneventful, aside from an occasional chat, within a couple of hours Swift Wind began to descend from the sky and the sights of the volcanic region showed up in view, scores of scorched trees and ashes floating through the air like snow were among the most immediate features that presented themselves to the three.

It took a few seconds of circling before Swift Wind managed to find a clear space in the scorched woods and landed onto the soot covered ground. "Well this is as close as Calderon as we can get without crossing into their border and well…causing a diplomatic error" Adora said as she got off of Swift Wind, disembarking and pulling out a small bag from the saddle, unzipping it and handing a wrapped sandwich over to Frosta.

"Oh! Wow, sourdough bread huh?" Frosta mused happily as she started unwrapping the sandwich and hungrily looking at it. Adora

nodded and unwrapped her own sandwich, taking a bite out of it. While chewing on it she handed some oats to Swift Wind who happily munched on them. They ate their food in silence, waiting for the arrival of the Calderon diplomatic party.

Frosta decided to walk around while they ate and spotted a pillar of smoke in the distance, she squinted her eyes and leaned a bit forward, trying to get a better understanding of what this smoke was or whatever its source was. She took a bite of her sandwich before looking into the woods and seeing a squad of Ziadroth warriors, their red armor stuck out amongst the charred trees.

Frosta, in her panic, tried to yell only for the food to get stuck in her throat, causing her to cough loudly. Adora ran over to Frosta and went to help her, Frosta spat out the food by the time Adora ran over to her. "ZIADROTH!!" Frosta yelled, but it was already too late as several squads of warriors were aiming their weapons at them.

Scorpia stepped out of the trees, the Trio was behind her. Adora readied her sword while Frosta summoned her ice gauntlets and Swift Wind reared his head and snorted angrily. "Great, so you brought an army huh? Where's Gareth hm?! Too full of himself to show himself?!" Adora yelled angrily.

Scorpia smirked "well, Gareth's not here…but the Empress is" the right hand of the royal family proudly declared. Adora's eyes went wide as the sounds of footsteps echo through the air, Adora looked towards the path east of her where the footsteps were heading towards herself and her team.

Catra's voice danced amongst the trees, carried amongst the wind, bringing an icy chill to Adora's soul, and indeed her very flesh seemed to be kissed by the icy singing that Catra's singing brought down onto her. The sword of protection shook gently within her grasp as the Warriors parted and, in the ashen fog, Catra's eyes glowed even more fiercely…

" *Vetrarnætur blóðs og stáls Stríð meðal blóðsins Vá! Burt til Eþeníu við róum Sléttum breytt í ösku Rústaðu ökrunum og brenndu það allt Vá! Burt til Eþeníu við róum Hljómið hornin Óvinurinn mun óttast Leystu stríðsóp okkar úr læðingi Vá! Baráttan um Eþeníu er okkar Vá! Víkingar búa sig undir stríð Vá! Fyrir orrustuna við Eþeníu Vá! Þetta er eitthvað sem vert er að berjast fyrir Vá! Fyrir orrustuna við Eþeníu Finnurðu bragðið af blóði mannsins Finnurðu bragðið af sigrinum Vá! Ertu tilbúinn að deyja? í stríði? Vá! Fyrir orrustuna við Eþeníu* "* Catra's song ended once she was within a few feet from Adora who looked like all the color had drained from her face…

3 years…3 years since Adora had last seen Catra. Sure…Gareth was something she could handle. Especially on the battlefield where she could focus her mind on the objective, but there was to be no battle, especially on the cusp of diplomacy. As much as Adora wanted to lash out, to fight and scream…she couldn't, she was on a mission of peace and it was clear Catra knew this with absolute *frightening* accuracy. Adora couldn't pin it down, but seeing Catra in this new outfit, the outfit that fits the image of the Empress of the most violent faction Etheria has ever seen…Adora couldn't help but feel her sins digging into her back, especially as sweat rolled down her back.

Something about Catra was causing Adora to simply be covered in fear, and it's something she had absolutely no idea of what was

causing it. Catra placed her hands on her hips, awaiting a response of any kind. She simply smirked and chuckled…”kveðja Adora”** she said, the Ziadrothan language danced its way out of her mouth and it felt like it stroked her ears with the demanding presence of some sort of predatory god. Adora shakily spoke ”c-catra…” was all she could say to the Empress of Ziadroth.

Frosta looked up at Adora, and could see how terrified she was, she couldn’t help but realize that the exact same fear that Adora was feeling was the same emotion that was coursing through her. She couldn’t understand it, was Catra casting a spell? How was Catra inflicting such a powerful fear in them??

Even Swift Wind was afflicted with this grave fear that was causing him to lower his head and wings, an animal instinct to make himself as small as possible. None of the Ziadrothans were affected by this, but they were clearly confused by the terrified stances that were being inflicted upon the 3 Coalition foes, especially with Adora…one of their greatest threats.

Scorpia blinked a couple times as Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio were exchanging glances in confusion. Scorpia shifted her gaze over to Catra and noticed something that she wasn’t sure was a trick of the light or something else…but Catra’s eyes, every few seconds had a pulse of purplish color that emanated like the ripples of a pond. Catra was unintentionally casting some sort of extremely powerful magic and Scorpia had no idea how Catra was casting it, she wasn’t even sure if Catra was even *aware* of the magic she was casting such a spell. Scorpia couldn’t tell what was even more surprising, that Catra was casting magic…or that she had never seen a magic that was purple in color…

Translations:

*the first few lines of Peyton Parrish's "Battle for York" but with York replaced with Etheria and translated into Icelandic

**"Greetings Adora", basically the closest I could do to Hey Adora.

Chapter 8: Flintecca

Chapter 8:

Flintecca

Adora felt entrapped by her own fear, wondering if Catra was going to kill them right then and there. But to her surprise, Catra threw her head back and laughed before waving her hand. The Warriors lowered their weapons, but the Trio still had their weapons armed. “I know what this Fire Princess wants, no violence between the ambassadors, so let's not be hostile...hm?” Catra explained, crossing her arms across her chest. Like a dam breaking, Adora and her party felt the fear draining from themselves and no longer felt imprisoned by it. That didn’t, however, alleviate the fact that somehow Catra had all 3 of them locked down just by looking at them. Adora let out a huge gasp of air as her knees wobbled gently.

“I…thought Gareth would be here.” Adora said with a significant degree of exasperation to which Catra smiled. “Adora, we both know that Gareth is many things. A great guy, amazing commander, wonderful emperor, badass husband…but not a diplomat.” she said lightheartedly. Adora slowly sheathed her weapon and nudged Frosta to stand down. Frosta took a few seconds before she let her ice gauntlets fall down. Adora always felt guilty whenever her mind drifted to her siblings, in the heat of battle she and Gareth didn’t get to talk but…with Catra here. Things felt different, even the Ziadrothans present could feel it as well.

“This isn’t going to be like the princess prom right? You aren’t going to blow stuff up huh?” Frosta said to which Scorpia tapped her claws together and sucked in air through her teeth. “Sorry about that by the way” Scorpia muttered to which Lonnie rolled her eyes and patted Scorpia on the back. Catra chuckled “oh please, like we’d blow up a volcano.” her casual smirk was ever present, like this was a day out on the field. “Besides, not sure if you know this, but Flintecca said she’ll meet up at 4:55pm” Catra explained to which Swift Wind and Adora exchanged glances.

“Wait, Calderon is advanced enough to have clocks?” Adora said with a degree of surprise. Catra raised an eyebrow “yeah…she sent Ziadroth an electronic message. I assumed Arrow Boy received a message as well?”, this time Catra genuinely sounded confused. “We actually got a letter, made of some parchment and stuff. Flintecca told us to meet us 5 minutes before the Evening bell” Adora explained, Catra still looked confused and the confusion spread amongst the Ziadrothans. Adora lowered her shoulders and sighed “That would be 4:55pm for us”

“My Empress, I'm getting red flags. This might be a trap, why else go through two entirely different methods of communication?” Lonnie suggested to which Catra nodded. Adora had to admit, she didn’t like it either. “Look, Catra…I don’t want to fight. Not now okay?” Adora said calmly to which Catra looked away and grit her teeth a bit. She nodded “yeah, not now for me either. I got my own reasons” she said gently. Adora offered a small smile and was about to talk when Catra shot her a slight glare.

“Make no mistake, Adora, we’re still at war.” Catra said harshly which caused Adora to stop in her tracks a bit. There was a tense silence before Scorpia spoke up “ooooooookaaaaaaaaay! Maybe we have some food? Hm? I mean we’re all here 3 hours early!”

Scorpia said with a smile. Adora glared at Scorpia "I swear you touch me with a Ration Bar i'm going to start punching". Despite this obvious threat the Ziadrothans began to laugh, with Catra laughing the hardest. The laughter went about for a solid minute. "Odin's Beard Adora! You really think me and Gareth would allow that shit? Nah nah, we actually make food now!" Catra said, wiping a tear from her eye.

Catra turned her gaze to a squad of soldiers and placed a hand on her hip. "Grab everyone food from the Landboat. We'll be here a while." she said before looking over at Adora. "So tell me, what's the food like over at Brightmoon?" the Empress of Ziadroth asked the Warrior Queen of Brightmoon. "Our food is good, I would even say civilized! We employ fruits, veggies and seafood. We also have access to clean drinking water and very impressive wines" Adora said with a proud smile only to be met with Catra's smugness which seemed to grow even more. Catra didn't really say anything, the waft of food coming in spoke for her.

The soldiers came back with large carts full of meat, starchy vegetables, gravies and all kinds of heavy foods. There were even large packs of canned drinks and a sizable barrel of some kind of drink. Adora's eyes went wide as the Soldiers removed their helmets and started stacking their plates with meats and all kinds of stuff. Catra grabbed a can and cracked it open, smiling to herself and leaned against a tree. "What the fuuuuck…" Frosta muttered to herself. Adora looked at the food and at Catra before looking back at the food. "How do you…" Adora's voice trailed off.

"We have made indoor farms in Ziadroth, Hydroponic bays as well. We have access to huge supplies of fatty meat, stuff like potatoes and celery. Everything to keep our warriors happy and full. Oh and Entrapta invented carbonators so we can make fizzy

drinks.” Catra explained before taking a large sip of her fizzy drink. Scorpia grabbed a horn and filled it up with the alcoholic drink, she smiled at Adora. “Wanna have some Mead?” Scorpia said with a smile, Adora raised an eyebrow and noticed a bunch of soldiers having Mead which was clearly the alcoholic drink that Ziadroth specialized in. she looked over at Catra with a sense of confusion, it's not like Catra to pass up an alcoholic drink…Adora’s eyes went as wide as moons.

“Catra…you’re…” Adora’s voice trailed off as Catra nodded and gently patted her stomach. “Found out when we departed from Ziadroth. It's also why I don’t want to fight.” Catra explained and took another sip of her drink as Adora was surprised, but at the same time she understood. Adora wouldn’t know what to do if Glimmer was hurt and they lost the baby, She wouldn’t have that on her conscience. Scorpia gently sipped from her mead, keeping a close eye on the 3 coalition members. Her brow furrowed, she felt a nudge and she turned her head over to her side and saw Kyle. “oh hey Kyle, what’s up?” Scorpia cheerfully said. “Just wanted to check how you were and all…” Kyle admitted, Scorpia smiled sweetly.

She was about to open her mouth when she noticed a few embers drifting in the wind followed by the smell of smoke. She turned her head towards the approaching cloud of fire, smoke and embers that were coming their way. Scorpia’s eyes went wide “uhhh…guys?” she said with fear quaking in her voice. Everyone present turned their heads towards the oncoming cloud of volcanic ash. The Ziadrothans dropped everything and grabbed their weapons while Adora summoned her blade and readied. Swift Wind stood in defiance of the oncoming storm as Frosta summoned gauntlets of ice, readying herself for an incoming fight.

A loud, borderline psychotic, cackling was heard from the cloud. In the smoke, a pair of glowing flame-orange eyes made themselves visible first, followed by a series of other glows of this figure. She was easily a few inches taller than Adora, her skin was a dark ashen-grey with glowing molten veins that seemed to focus around her arms and face, forming strange striped patterns across her body. Everything down past her forearms and her knees was glowing, as if there were pools of magma just below the surface of her skin. Still, this figure's most striking features included her molten-lava like hair and eyes that resembled burning coals. She wore a rather basic tunic bearing tattered ends, dyed a deep crimson color. The tunic itself lacked much in terms of decoration, surprisingly brutalist in design, as for footwear was a pair of winged sandals. When the cloud dissipated, the woman was surrounded by two squads of warriors clad head-to-toe in what appears to be obsidian-like armor.

The woman raised her arms out over her head and spread them out, moving them towards her hips and placing her hands upon them. "Wow…wow wow. Hello Coalition and Ziadroth! I'm your esteemed badass-extraordinaire Princess of Calderon! I am Flintecca!" she said with a big toothy grin and a very unnecessary bow, she kept her eyes locked on everyone while her soldiers remained completely motionless, unflinching towards the environment around them. Catra and Adora stepped forward to introduce themselves but Flintecca stuck her hand out and wagged her finger at them. "Hup-up-up! Don't introduce yourselves, lemme take a guess!" Flintecca said with a chuckle. Adora smiled and crossed her arms, while Catra placed a hand on her hip and rolled her eyes a bit.

Flintecca looked over at Adora and smirked "the *Legendary* Adora herself! The current She-Ra and Warrior Queen of Brightmoon. Call me a conspiratorial nutjob, but I'm fairly certain everything changed when you picked up that Sword. Still though, one of the finest warriors on the planet!" Flintecca leaned back and waited

for Adora's response, upon seeing Adora's surprise the fire princess simply winked. She then looked over at Catra.

"And you, the *Empress of Ziadroth* herself! The mighty Catra! You and Gareth led a revolution of legend and overthrew Hordak! Causing the destruction of the Horde itself! Hell you did more than that! You made a nation unlike anything this planet's ever seen! Ziadroth! Pinnacle of industrial might and progress!" Flintecca said with the same enthusiasm she had when describing Adora. She smirked as Catra also displayed the same level of shock. Catra made a time-out gesture and shook her head rapidly, causing her mane to swing back and forth. "Uh uh, no fuck that! How the hell do you know this shit?!" Catra said pointing right at Flintecca as the Ziadrothans were packing stuff up but also keeping a close eye on what was going on. Specifically the Trio and Scorpia, who were ready to jump into battle at a moment's notice.

Flintecca smugly shrugged her shoulders "oh come now, you think Calderon didn't keep tabs on things? You'd be surprised how much criminal underworld contracts, contacts and just overall stuff my dad used to keep an eye on people. Honestly it's how I knew how to contact the Coalition and Ziadroth in the most efficient ways possible" the princess of Calderon explained with a small tilt of her head and a gleam in her eye. Flintecca looked over at Catra with a small cruel smirk, which brought confusion to the Queen and Empress. "You know, I even know you have a special prisoner. While Adora has a guest you'd be very much interested in." Flintecca mused cruelly which caused the Queen and Empress to look at each other with a rather violent suspicion. Flintecca chuckled and flicked her lava hair from side to side and turned her back on them.

“Ahhh! But enough introductions! Let's make our way to Calderon!” Flintecca said as she began to walk very slowly. Frosta and Swift Wind made their way to Adora’s side as Catra shouted orders for the Ziadrothan warriors, Scorpia and the Trio to follow her. Adora’s heart was racing again as she waited for Catra, Scorpia and the trio to be out of earshot before she spoke. “Flintecca knows about Weaver” Adora said to Frosta without looking directly at her. Frosta’s eyes went wide as Swift Wind tried his best not to look shocked. “Adora…what’s going to happen if Flintecca drops that information?” Frosta asks Adora, given how she’s the resident Catra expert currently present.

“I don’t know...she’s different from the last time we saw each other. But I feel like she would set her sights on us, but what’s really gotten me confused is what Flintecca referred to as a special prisoner.” Adora said, trying to process what that was about. Frosta grabbed Adora’s hand and tugged it “hey! Let’s not get left behind okay!” Frosta yelled, Adora nodded and followed Flintecca, the Calderonians and the Ziadrothans. Frosta and Swift Wind were right by Adora’s side. Within a few minutes, Adora and her group were right next to the Ziadrothans. Adora exhaled a sigh of relief when she realized she didn’t miss anything in regards to Calderonian history due to the fact Flintecca remained somewhat quiet. Catra looked over at Adora with an inquisitive look before focusing on the path before her. Adora opened her mouth to say something but Flintecca spoke up.

“Well we got a hour’s walk before we wind up at the gates of my lovely kingdom, so how about I regale you with a brief history of Calderon?” Flintecca said looking over her shoulder at the two groups, her big grin was evident before took notice of Frosta. She suddenly thrusted her hand up which caused the Calderonian soldiers to stop in her tracks. “What’s *she* doing here?” Flintecca asked Adora. Adora blinked and looked at Frosta, then back at Flintecca. “Wh-what? I thought you noticed her?” Adora asked,

genuinely surprised by this. Flintecca's glare was volcanic, spouts of flame jutted from her mouth but before she could open her mouth, Frosta yelled out a response.

"I came here to rectify the mistake my parents made! They wronged your mother and your family! I want to make things right!" Frosta yelled, Adora was surprised by what Frosta said but she kept her mouth shut for the moment. It took a second, but Adora realized what Frosta was trying to do. Flintecca's harsh expression instantly faded, she clearly wasn't expecting such a response. "Wh-what?" she asked. Frosta took a deep breath and exhaled "That ambush, what my parents did…leaving your mom behind? That isn't right. That's why I came here with Adora! To show that i'm not like them! Could…could you please give me a chance? Like you are giving the Coalition a chance?" Frosta said with a most sincere look in her eyes.

Flintecca looked away for a moment and then looked right back at Frosta. "S-sure…" Flintecca said gently. Catra seemed a tad bit annoyed that such a tactic worked but Adora didn't mind, especially if this tactic would be the ultimate key in having Calderon join the Coalition. Flintecca, despite the genuine surprise and a rather heartfelt moment, went back to her more cheery self within a few minutes.

"Oh right, yeah as I was saying. The Kingdom of Calderon is often mistaken for being in the region of Mount Candila. There's an old saying that Calderon is in its heart. You'd be surprised to know that Calderon *IS* Mount Candila! Our ancestors hollowed out much of the volcano and have made a massive city out of it." Flintecca smirked to herself and looked over at Catra. "We used to be able to boast about how our city was the largest in the world. But then Ziadroth was born with a megacity that covers the entire eastern

part of the continent! All that empty wasteland and mountains behind the Fright zone, transformed and merged into a megacity of all things! It's impressive!” Flintecca said, giving a polite bow over to Catra.

The Empress of Ziadroth smirked and tilted her head somewhat as they walked. “Damn right it is, especially that it was built within 3 years thanks to all the ancient technology that Hordak was stockpiling for a reason he conveniently forgot. It allows us to construct whatever we want and build everything we need. Oh and it isn't just a surface-level city either, we got sublevels and stuff too! Ziadroth extends well over 10 kilometers beneath the surface. A completely self-sufficient city and nation of intense industry, labor force aaaaand just about whatever you can imagine. But more than that, we are warriors” Catra proudly conveyed, which the Ziadrothans let out a brief warcry of approval. Adora rolled her eyes and kept walking. Flintecca, however, wasn’t done talking as they marched. “So, Catra’s got one hell of a pitch! Got anything to say about The Coalition Adora?” Flintecca asked as they began to walk up a steadily increasing incline. The Calderonians were able to climb it just fine, though it was steadily wearing down on the others. Adora, however, did her best to answer the Fire Princess’ question.

“Sure, we may not be the most advanced people on the planet. But we have magic, lots of it. Access to Mystacor, furthermore we allow sovereignty of all members. We aren’t one singular nation like Ziadroth, we’re a group of nations that decided that we weren’t rebels anymore. We have equal representation, all nations have their voices heard. Simple as that” Adora explained, walking over a hurdle. Flintecca nodded a bit to this as she ran her hand through her volcanic hair.

“Well those are both nice pitches, basically having me choose between technology and magic. Something my people both have access too” Flintecca mused loudly to which Catra and Adora exchanged looks. At this point they were on a rather hard-to-spot mountain trail that led up Mount Candila. They were standing before two hefty volcanic stone doors “Ziadroth! Coalition! I bid you welcome to Calderon!” Flintecca said with a bow worthy of a ringmaster as the Calderonian soldiers opened to gates to reveal Calderon itself.

The immense city was exactly as Flintecca stated it was, a massive city built out of a hollowed out Volcano. But surprisingly a strange blend of technology and magic was displayed all across this city that seemed to go up for a long time. The mouth of the volcano was a tiny speck from where everyone stood, like that of an artificial sun.

Frosta had heard about what Calderon once looked like from her parents, but seeing it before her as it currently is made her realize how much a society can warp when its cut off from the rest of the world.

Chapter 9: Hotbox Negotiations

Chapter 9:

Hotbox Negotiations

Calderon’s many buildings were built on discs of some kind, and each disc was a sector of the vast city, with a sizable hole in each of them so that the sunlight from Mount Candila’s mouth could go through. However, in most cases, the light came from either geothermal-powered lamps or magically infused torches.This is what made the blend so strange, where magical and technological innovations were overlapping each other in form and function.

The people were physically alike to Flintecca with the exception of lava hair. Though their hair were vibrant colors of yellow, gold, orange and red. Their architecture, their designs and even their basic clothing reflected a brutalist, minimalist style. Compared to Ziadroth who proudly displays a militaristic and barbaric cultural style that draws inspiration from the ancient norse culture of humanity...Calderon seems to have a style that almost seems boring.

However, as diplomats from The Coalition and Ziadroth soon came to realize, the sacrifice of style was worth it for pure functionality, everything ran smoothly and was maintained effectively. Even the very floors were kept neat and tidy, much to Adora’s surprise. Adora looked over at Catra “how do you keep your megacity clean?” Adora asked Catra, the empress smirked and chuckled. “Robots.” She said simply and plainly. Adora nodded and was about to return to focusing on her surroundings when one of the Ziadrothans spoke up.

“Forgive me for interrupting *Queen* Adora, but how do you keep Brightmoon clean?” Lonnie asked with a hint of smarm, sharing a fist bump with Kyle when she asked her question. Adora glared at Lonnie, for a few moments. “We have people for that” Adora said plainly which brought a snarling chuckle from Rogelio and an eye roll from Kyle. The Trio, especially Lonnie, are not to be underestimated. It's no surprise Catra brought them with her, they are easily among the deadliest warriors at Ziadroth’s disposal.

Rogelio, a monstrously powerful specimen of a Luzargan, is a loyal warrior. However, despite him not being able to physically compare to Gareth, Scorpia or herself, Adora knows Rogelio is a ruthless opponent. She remembers Rogelio ruthlessly pursuing opponents during the Horde War; she has no doubt that in the Great War he is going to rack up a horrific kill count.

Kyle, he’s always had a gentle heart when they grew up. He may not be the most physically capable or even one meant for diplomacy. But he was an emotional anchor and a hell of a sharpshooter. He one time used a slingshot to take out a spider across the cafeteria. Such a natural prodigy of accuracy has resulted in him being a hell of a good sniper. Adora should know, during the Horde battle of Plumera, she got a shot through her shoulder because of Kyle.

Lonnie...the leader of the Trio. She had qualities that overlapped with Catra, Gareth and herself. She was strong physically and in willpower, a determined leader and an astounding combatant. But more than that, Adora knows something that Light Hope told her. If it wasn’t for Adora being here on Etheria, the sword would have chosen Lonnie. Adora couldn’t imagine what a Lonnie-Ra would be

capable of, especially considering Lonnie didn't have any of the moral codes that Adora had sworn to uphold.

Their walk across the disc seemed to last a long time, ducking through streets and alleyways. Calderon was built like a damn labyrinth, unlike Brightmoon or Ziadroth, it was as if the buildings were placed down first and the streets were an afterthought at best. Still though, many Calderonians were watching the march that the princess was leading.

"Sooo, are we going to go up a lift?" Frosta asked, feeling her legs getting sore already. She didn't want to go up stairs, especially a mountain's worth of stairs, Flintecca looked at the Ice Princess and smirked. "Oh definitely! What? You think we use stairs? Our city is a hollowed out volcano! Of course we got lifts! In fact we're approaching one!" Flintecca extended a finger towards a large volcanic stone pillar that extended far into the ceiling of the current disc...which also counted as the floor of the disc above them. Adora looked up in sheer awe, she could hear Scorpia let out an impressive whistle. Swift Wind snorted and stamped his hoof "flying's still better." Adora rolled her eyes and patted Swift Wind's snout, one of the Ziadrothan Warriors spoke up "did...did that fucking horse just talk?"

Swift Wind looked at the warrior dead in the eye. "Well, *technically* I would be a Alicorn you uncultured-" Adora rolled her eyes and nudged Swift Wind, interrupting him. Flintecca smirked and boarded the lift along with her Calderonians. The massive lift could easily have been used to carry tons of cargo, supplies, people...you name it. The lift was well over the size of a large house and despite it being able to carry so much. Flintecca was using it like a personal lift for herself and the diplomatic delegations she had with her.

Adora didn’t pay it too much mind, it was something royals did after all. Sure it was a bit inefficient, but at the same time, if the system worked for this nation there was no need to fix it. She wasn’t going to force Flintecca to adjust something like this, especially since that would mean a drain on Calderon’s resources and worse yet, she would be forcing Brightmoon values on another nation.

Catra felt a tinge of disgust, seemed like something the force captains would do when she was a child soldier. A gross misuse of resources, hard working people could use this lift and not self-entitled royals. Food could be distributed or anything like that. The Empress held her tongue, but she was already imagining personal lifts for administrative personnel once Ziadroth had this place under her and Gareth’s control.

The lift glowed with lava and fire magic and the lift began to rise. “Our next stop is my home! The royal palace of Calderon!” Flintecca said with an excited smile. The delegations talked amongst themselves as the lift continued its gentle ascent...when suddenly the lift stopped dead in its tracks and powered down. The sudden jolt caused the Ziadrothans to pull out their weapons while the Coalition members reached for their own weapons. Flintecca let out a very frustrated sigh, so frustrated was she that her breath became plumes of fire and ash. She took a few quick breaths before calming down, she then stomped her foot on the lift, unleashing a massive amount of lava to surge into the Lift which caused its ascent to progress far more than it was previously. The lift lurched violently towards the peak of Mount Candila.

“FUUUUUCKING FUCKSHITTERS!!!! CRISPY ASSBULLCRAPPERRRRRRS!!!!” Adora screamed at the top of her lungs, saying something she picked up from Glimmer. The Ziadrothans were screaming in their strange native language. Frosta yelled and Swift Wind managed to avoid the sudden surge of motion by trying to fly as much as he could. Within a half-minute, they were at the top floor. Flintecca ran her hands through her hair and flicked a few specks of lava flew from her hair and landed on the lift around her. “We’ll talk about that once we get inside” Flintecca explained as she walked ahead. The top disc was where the Fortress-mansion of Flintecca’s family resided on the northern end of the disc. In the center, hovering on a strange display was the Runestone of Fire. Known as the Spirit Ember.

Frosta looked at it with a cursory glance, she nudged Adora which prompted Adora to look at it as well. “It's beautiful.” Adora said with a sense of awe. Frosta nodded, the light of the sun shined directly onto the Spirit Ember and bathed the entire courtyard in flame-colored light that seemed to flicker like an actual fire. “Please! Everyone into Lava Manor!” Flintecca said as her Calderonian guards waited by the gates of the fortress-mansion. The Ziadrothans and the Coalition members entered the rather extravagant manor, it was a complete far cry from the rest of the city. In fact, it seemed like this manor was built before the rest of the buildings that overcrowded the discs below due to the sheer differences.

Flintecca’s servants welcomed her home with pleasantries as she led her guests to a large room. The room was the size of a small movie theater, with no windows but a large overhead lamp that seemed to have an unending flame burning in its heart. The room had barely any furnishings besides for a large circular table carved not from rock or minerals...or even steel. But from some sort of wood, the wood itself defied identification to everyone present.

Flintecca sat at the northern end of the table on a large obsidian throne, she gestured for the Coalition members to sit on the right side of the table and the Ziadrothans to sit on the left side of the table. The air suddenly grew tense as Adora sat across from Catra, Frosta sat across from Scorpia and Lonnie sat across from Swift Wind.

Flintecca took a deep breath and exhaled, leaning back on her throne. “So...as you can probably ascertain, my kingdom has been suffering breakdowns all across the board. We have been experiencing this for a long time...but in the past 5 years? It's gotten far far worse. It's also why i...reached out to both superpowers.” Flintecca stated, her voice growing somewhat grim. Catra leaned back in her chair and pulled out a switchblade, gently sharpening her fangs using it. Despite this, she was listening intently. Frosta looked...concerned as if she could understand what the Fire Princess was going to say. Adora kept her eyes on Flintecca throughout this entire conversation.

Flintecca swallowed some air before speaking, this Truth was hard to explain. “Our...Volcano is dying. Mount Candila will soon be no more...if... *WHEN* it dies it will mean the end of our home. Our technology, based on the immense cache of First Ones technology we still have, will be rendered without a power source, I have so many people who rely on this technology more than our magic. I’m not even sure if the Runestone will survive without Mount Candila, given how entwined the two are...a symbiotic relationship that has existed since the Runestone was made.” Flintecca explained grimly, looking at both the Queen and the Empress in equal measure.

“So...whoever had the best plan to restore your Volcano or provide a solution on keeping the runestone powered when it

dies...you'll dedicate your kingdom to?" Adora asked as Catra put away her switchblade and stopped leaning on her chair. Flintecca nodded "and I need immediate solutions, the Volcano may not even last the next couple years" Catra smirked and scratched the side of her ear and leaned forward onto the table. "Well we have methods on jumpstarting geothermal vents when we were making Ziadroth years ago." Catra boasted with a smirk, she looked at Flintecca, watching her expression of growing interest. "I mean sure, those were tiny volcanic vents. Furthermore we shut those down once we had working nuclear power plants to fuel the entire megacity, but I can see our method doing the same thing to Mount Candila…just bigger" Catra explained. Flintecca leaned forward and towards Catra.

"And what is this method? Some sort of device?" Flintecca asked to which Scorpia smiled excitedly and was about to explain but Catra patted her on the shoulder as a way to get her to stand down. Scorpia sat right back down, but kept her smile. "Actually we use a bunch of water, preferably very cold water, and dump it in the vent." Catra said in a simple, matter-of-fact way. Flintecca's eyes went a bit wide and she shook her head "but that would cause an eruption! Sure the volcano would be re-ignited but…" Flintecca's voice trailed off. "First off, your people would be evacuated before this all happened. And secondly, an eruption of Mount Candila would do wonders against The Coalition, being a volcano and all." Catra said with a smirk. Adora was about to speak up but Flintecca spoke before Adora even had a chance.

"Too Risky, besides the costs for rebuilding would be way too much. Even if Ziadroth will help rebuild, I'm not sure we would be able to fight back the inevitable Coalition counter attack" Flintecca stated, giving Adora a brief glance before looking back at Catra. Catra took a deep breath as her eye twitched out of impatience. Lonnie leaned over and whispered something into Catra's ear which got her to calm down. "I'm sure that our head scientist

would be able to devise a solution given time" Catra stated, Adora had a big smirk and leaned back in her chair. "Oh yeah? And where is Entrapta?" she asked to which Catra snarled a bit and crossed her arms, muttering a response that equated to the fact that Catra did not bring Entrapta along.

Flintecca looked over at Adora and nodded to her, indicating it was her turn to speak. Adora cleared her throat and nodded. "She-Ra is capable of many things, I managed to heal the Plumeran Runestone. Re-igniting a Volcano shouldn't be too much work" Adora explained, looking over at Catra with a smug look that only got her even more upset. "Well, hopefully you'll be able to demonstrate such power. Thus far it seems the Coalition has the most viable option for me and my people" the fire princess mused before looking over at Adora and then over at Catra. Catra snarled a bit "I hardly think this is fair, given how this is such a diplomatic issue that literally determines which way your kingdom would go. I would say that you should have included that in your invitation" Catra said angrily.

Adora was about to debate Catra about it but then she realized that she made a good point. Because if Adora didn't come along and Glimmer was sent instead, they would be losing this diplomatic battle. She leaned back and offered a small curious raising of the eyebrow as Flintecca leaned back in her throne a bit. "True I should have, but given the information I gleaned from the spy network Calderon has made me cautious. If I had mentioned, or even hinted that Calderon's power was waning, who's to say I would be inviting armies at my kingdom and not diplomats?" Flintecca asked both parties. Both parties, in return, didn't say a word and simply sat there in stunned silence.

Catra finally spoke up, however. "Okay, well then in *that* case. Maybe you should give Ziadroth a timeframe of when Mount Candila is expected to die. Surely you have that in mind?" Catra said with crossed arms and a pout. Scorpia patted her on the shoulder while Lonnie glared at Adora and Flintecca. Flintecca narrowed her gaze at Catra and exhaled out of her nostrils.

"My Scholars stated that it would be 2 years at most. Considering how Ziadroth and The Coalition are more focused on wiping each other out. I doubt you'd be putting much effort into researching a way to save my kingdom and instead will find ways to help us with the runestone instead. By the way, my scholars have stated that it's very unlikely that the runestone will survive without Mount Candila. It's as if by design that the runestone is solely linked to the volcano's survival" Flintecca explained, rather harshly in tone, to Catra. The tension was already rising in the room and as if by instinct, the Calderonian soldiers entered the Lava Manor and waited outside the room.

Catra sighed and ran her hands through her hair, this diplomacy was pissing her off. Ziadroth needed a hail mary of a technology that is tailored to Flintecca's specifications. This cooperation was not going well, Adora tapped her fingers against the rim of the table. She leaned forward and spoke up. "Yes, things are very much in favor of the Coalition. But that makes me wonder if Glimmer was here instead of me, would you even *have* an option but to either wait on The Coalition to send me in or be forced to surrender sovereignty to Ziadroth in the hopes of a pipe dream." Adora harshly disputed, which seemed to bring a degree of chagrin to Flintecca who looked at her with a glare.

"Sure you gambled and won, but there was always bound to be some level of risk. I don't mean to insult you or berate you, but

you do know that in a world as uncertain as this with a War so hostile that some people are dubbing it as *The Great War* , this is hardly the time for doing such things" Adora explained, Frosta wanted to speak up but decided not to. Not yet anyways. "Fine, but I need a demonstration from you Adora. I need to be sure that this is the path I need to take. As for the Ziadrothans…I think we're done here then. Hm?" Flintecca said as Catra left large claw marks on the wooden table, she stood up and her squad of Ziadrothan warriors made their way to the exit. Scorpia and Lonnie exchanged concerned looks and made their way out.

"That's the last fucking time I ever deal with fucking diplomacy!" Catra snarled angrily, but before she could take another step. Someone called out her name, the Ziadrothans and their empress turned to look at a heavily armored Calderonian Soldier, the armor was rather advanced compared to the rest of the other soldiers. "Empress Catra, a word? If you please?" the Soldier asked, empress Catra folded her arms and scowled. She hoped this wasn't a waste of her time. "What is it?" she asked of the Calderonian. The Calderonian Soldier removed his helmet, revealing that he was certainly older than the Empress but given the vicious scar over his empty eye socket…he was a veteran of war.

"My name is Dotharn Gargo. I am not only Grand General of the Calderonian Military, but a member of a political faction of Technological-aligned Calderonians. I had hoped that the young princess would at least see reason, but I cannot stand by any longer. Our faction, made up of many Calderonians, wish to stand by Ziadroth." Dotharn explained, this gained Catra's interest. She smirked from ear to ear. "Alright Mr. Gargo. Though this won't come cheap, since we need a sign of loyalty" Catra explained. Dotharn grinned and reached for something behind him, pulling out a small half-orb shaped device. "This right here is information Flintecca would have shown you if she followed the path of

reason. This is the special guest that the Coalition have been hanging onto the entire time" Dotharn pressed a button on the device revealing holographic recordings of Shadow Weaver in Brightmoon. All with accurate dates and information.

Scorpia Gasped as the Trio stood there in shock. Catra however, looked at the hologram with eyes wide open, her ears lowered down with tears of frustration building up. She touched her own stomach in a defensive gesture. Catra blinked a few times before rubbing her eyes dry. She clenched her fists angrily before looking at Dotharn with the fiery gaze of a warrior Empress.

What came out of Catra's mouth were 5 words. "Welcome to the Ziadrothan Army"

Chapter 10: Volcanic Civil War

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The doors to the Calderonian Technologist headquarters opened with a hiss that was familiar to the Ziadrothans, something that reminded them of home. Catra entered the room, her boots tapping against the shiny metal floor. Catra examined everywhere, especially how expansive everything is. Catra looked at Dotharn and crossed her arms, "so, if i'm not mistaken, this also allowed Flintecca to send a message across the continent?" The Empress inquired. Dotharn nodded "indeed! Why do you ask?". The Ziadrothans spread out and got themselves comfortable, a bit of respite for what was now inevitable. Catra, on her force captain days, probably would have launched the attack immediately. But she knows better these days, and she has a plan.

"I need to contact Ziadroth, if we all want to get out of here with a sizable amount of cargo. We need to divide our forces, obviously me and my friends are going to take the faster route. You and your men will join mine on the Landboat we parked in the woods outside of Mount Candila. With that in mind, only one transport can get here fast enough." Catra said as she let Dotharn lead her to the main communications console. Catra immediately went to work, it wasn't that far off the ancient Horde tech that Ziadroth technology was built off of, So Catra was able to work out a message. Lonnie looked up at the large screen and noticed what Catra was requesting. "The *Muninn* ? My Empress, is that a good idea? We only had that thing for a couple months, and I'm positive Entrapta started calling the AI the ship has as *Darla* before we left." Lonnie inquired as she maintained a rigid militant stance, looking at Catra's message with specific details.

“I know, but what choice do we have? The Muninn’s the fastest craft in the Ziadrothan airforce and it can get here within a few minutes. Pluuuuus it has the capacity for me, you guys, Scorps and valuable First Ones tech cargo along with whoever Gareth brings along” Catra explains as she finishes off the message but before she hits the send key she looks at Dotharn. “Any secret hangars or vehicle bays around here that Flintecca doesn’t know about?” Catra asked the general of Calderon, he nodded and walked over to the console and typed in the coordinates into the message. Catra hesitated over the send key, she looked over at Dotharn. “If this is a trick, or anything even remotely resembling a betrayal…you will die, you understand?” Catra said with a glare. “Ziadroth does not tolerate traitors" she said with a small feline hiss to which Dotharn nodded, his expression not changing one bit. “I understand my Empress” he said plainly.

Elsewhere within Calderon, Adora and her companions walked with Flintecca. They had just taken a lift down to the lowest levels of the Volcano. Compared to the rest of the place, the Volcano’s lowest level was the hottest and actually felt like it was a Volcano, Adora felt the sweat roll down her back as Frosta conjured up ice to cool herself off and also cool off Swift Wind. They entered a large volcanic rock chamber, massive in size, and at the center of this strange chamber was a massive pit of bubbling lava, much of it was hardened. Leaving only a few holes of lava to peek out and bubble gently. It was like it was being blocked by the hardened rock.

“Here we are, whatever’s left of Candila’s power is resting right here. You awaken the power, Adora and you’ll see Calderon light up like you’ve never seen it before!” Flintecca said with a raised fist of glory, grinning to herself. Adora nodded and turned her

bracelet into the sword of protection, Adora took a deep breath before yelling.

"FOR THE HONOR OF GRAYSKULL!"

In a breathtaking flash of iridescent light, where an average sized woman stood, now was an 8 foot tall warrior with long flowing golden hair and adorned in a near mystical white-gold armor. The Sword of Protection held firmly in her hand while a winged crown adorns her head. Flintecca was in awe, her eyes widened as the light shone over her. Flecks of her lava hair flying away from the wind…or whatever force emanated from Adora.

Frosta smirked and nudged Flintecca and winked. "Yep! That's She-Ra!" Frosta said with a big grin, looking up at the absolutely flabbergasted Flintecca. Though the shock on her face didn't last long as she grinned excitedly and cheered on Adora "THAT IS AWESOME!!". Adora furled her brow as she tried to figure out how to do this. "Hmm…" Adora hummed to herself, being indecisive about it all. Swift Wind spoke up "hey! It could be like the Salineas Gate! Just aim the sword and unleash your energy!" Swift Wind said with a big smile, Adora looked over her shoulder and nodded at Swift Wind. she smiled and focused her sword at the bubbling lava pit.

Without a second thought Adora unleashed a coronal blast of magical energy at the pool of magma. The entire darkness of the chamber was filled with this coronal light for a few brief seconds before the light faded into a slight flashing as the energy broke through the rock and into the magma itself. "SO! HOW LONG IS THIS GONNA TAKE!" Flintecca yelled "I CAN SEND SOME GUYS UP FOR SNACKS IF WE NEED THEM!". Adora couldn't hear her, she

looked over her shoulder and squinted a bit. “WHAAAAT?” Adora yelled back as the laser continued to whine and roar loudly. “WHAT WAS THAT ABOUT CRACKS??”

Swift Wind rolled his eyes and did his telepathic communication with Adora. His horn glows as he relayed what Flintecca said. It took a second for Adora to process it before she nodded. “YES!! SNACKS WOULD BE GREAT FOR AFTER! SHOULD BE AT LEAST AN HOUR! NO IDEA HOW LONG FOR CERTAIN THOUGH!” Adora yelled over to Flintecca. Luckily Flintecca was able to understand that and nodded. She smiled and waited a bit, she looked over at one of her soldiers. “Say where’s Dotharn?” Flintecca asked of the soldiers, the soldier simply shrugged. Flintecca rolled her eyes and facepalmed “Reeeeeeally should find a way to keep an eye and ear on my troops. Or you know, keep them in touch. Mail really doesn’t work in a crammed volcano” Flintecca admitted to Frosta who simply sat and waited for Adora to be done with her re-awakening the Volcano.

About 20 minutes have passed and not much has happened, though Adora was making some level of progress upon the Volcano’s lava pit. Flintecca felt a bit bored, but stayed to make sure Adora needed help when she could but thus far not much was happening. Adora had closed her eyes as the beam was a bit difficult to constantly look at, instead using her other senses to keep the beam directing into the magma. She could feel the volcano’s energy *ever so slightly* waking up. The constant breaking up of rock and other bits that were clogging caused the lava to churn every so often. Adora was mentally counting up the time it was taking, 21 minutes now and there wasn’t much progress. However, minimal progress is still progress all the same. However Adora sighed and lowered her blade, stopping and wiping her forehead.

Flintecca shot her head up and looked at Adora. “Hey uhm…is it awake?” Flintecca asked. Adora shook her head, sweat dripping down her face. “Good news is that I'm making progress, the Volcano is responding well. Just…phew. I am NOT used to standing that close to an open lava pit.” Adora said, still in She-Ra form. She sunk her sword into the rock floor and let it rest a bit. Flintecca nodded, she seemed understanding of what was going on. “Well I mean, I doubt it's gonna take a year. But the sooner we do this the better” she urged Adora, the mighty warrior queen of brightmoon nodded and wiped some sweat off her brow and nodded. “Yeah I plan to get it done by the end of either today…or the next couple of days…” Adora said exhausted from the heat. Though if she was exhausted in her She-Ra form, its more than likely her base form would have passed out.

Adora reverted to her normal self and walked over to the cool parts of the chamber, dragging the sword along. Resting along the stone wall of the chamber a bit. Adora focused her Gray blue eyes onto Flintecca and moved a few blonde locks off her face. “Hey, think you can get us some sn-” Adora’s voice was cut off by a loud muffled explosion that seemed to come from the Disc above them. The Calderonian Soldiers readied up as the Coalition members got up as well, Adora readied herself despite her exhaustion. “What’s the disc above us?” Adora said with an exasperated growl, trying to force some level of awakeness inside her. Flintecca thrusted her arms into the volcanic rock and formed lava-infused claws. Akin to Frosta’s own ice fists, in execution but taking the form of wicked foot long claws.

“Military district! It’s where we keep our forces and our First Ones tech” Flintecca said, the moment those words left her word, another series of explosions hit the disc. Adora broke into a full sprint towards the lift, she knew what it was, she knew what was happening. The coalition, Calderonian Soldiers and Flintecca boarded the lift and it began to crawl upwards. “Adora what’s

happening!?” Flintecca said with a frustrated growl, more towards the situation than towards Adora herself. Adora took a few breaths to get herself out of exhaustion and looked at Flintecca. “You’re people, from the moment I saw them, are divided. One side wants to use Technology the other wants to use magic. Catra must’ve riled them up in order to salvage something from this!” Adora turned towards the Lift and the doors opened.

In that fraction of a second, they came under the barrage of Ziadrothan Automatic Rifles. Adora brought up her shield, formed from the Sword Of Protection while Frosta brought up an Ice Wall to block the barrage of bullets, however a few Calderonian soldiers caught bullets, with bullets breaking through them with frightening ease. Flintecca looked at the slumped soldiers as they lay where they fell, ceasing to breathe. Adora raised up her shield to see Calderonians with Ziadrothan weaponry. She pulled out her sword and screamed “FOR THE HONOR OF GRAYSKULL!”, She-Ra leaped into the air and landed into the crowd of Calderonian separatists, grabbing one by the neck and slamming him into the wall. “Who gave you these weapons!” Adora yelled looking the Calderonian in the eyes. The Calderonian struggled, he looked like he was in his late teens. Someone who shouldn’t even think about using a weapon in the first place. The defiant teen glared at Adora.

“The Empress and the Emperor!” the Teen snarled “but it's too late! They're making they’re way out of here! Calderon may be lost to you Coalition Dogs but it's true future lies in-” Adora shut the Teen up with a simple slap. Enough to make him shut up and judging by his shocked expression, it was clear that it was making him rethink his choices. All across the military disc, Calderonians fought each other, but that wasn’t what was on Adora’s mind. Gareth showed up, she didn’t know how. Adora looked at Swift Wind “Swifty! Quickly!” Adora called out, Swift Wind obeyed and ran to her side, Adora boarded onto Swift Wind and began to fly

off towards the western part of the Disc. Adora closed her eyes and focused, she could sense Apophis' energy…more specifically his godstone. Adora opened her eyes, Gareth was here somehow. It didn't make sense to Adora, how was that even *possible* ?. Adora and Swift Wind could see a curious sight, several squads of Calderonian Soldiers who were blocking off an exit, a simple hole in the wall of the mountain. Adora could sense Apophis' Godstone behind it, Swift Wind began his descent.

A wall of weapon fire responded, Calderonian Weapons were… different from Ziadrothan weapons. Instead of firing bullets, they fired balls of magma right at them. "SHIT!" Adora yelled as she felt the heat from the magma balls flung past her, some of them singing her hair as it ripped through the air. Adora aimed her blade and unleashed a blast of energy from it, they hit the traitorous Calderonians with a vengeful crack, many of them were vaporized on the spot. Adora leaped from Swift Wind and landed at the entrance, completely unharmed, but the very ground shattered beneath her boots. Adora glared angrily at several of the surviving traitors "you're lucky I got bigger bastards to face" she growled before violently kicking the doors open.

Adora had to cover her face to keep the sunlight from hurting her eyes, she squinted and was unprepared to see the sunlight in all its glory bearing down on her. But that wasn't what got her so unbelievably stunned. It was the shape of Mara's Ship, its incredible size parked into a large crater. It was restored to life, but in a way Adora wasn't expecting… It was painted in the colors of Ziadroth, with its sigil painted on the wings of the ship. Along with a Ziadrothan phrase painted in black runes across the front bow. Gareth approached Adora, with a spiteful look in his eyes but a cruel smirk. He was dragging someone wearing what Adora assumed was a prison uniform, a large bag was over the person's head. Gareth was aiming his shotgun at the man.

Catra stepped out from behind Gareth. Scorpia and the Trio also stepped out, looking fearsome as ever. Adora looked past them and could see Entrapta and…Hordak. The two were leading a pair of Calderonians with crates onto the ship. Adora was stunned "wh…what did you do to Mara's Ship? Who-who is that?" Adora looked at Mara's ship and then at the prisoner. She felt her heart pounding in her chest as the confusion wracked her.

The ship's speakers hummed to life and Entrapta's voice came from the ship's speakers. "We control the Crimson Wastes, Mara's ship is in the Crimson Wastes. We dug it up and we converted it, one day we'll have fleets of ships like Mara's. Ah but we won't be calling them that. This is the *Muninn* . The first of the *Dresvarpr* - Class Aircraft! This ship has everything including a personal teleporter! Sooo…hehehe" Entrapta cackled wickedly like a mad scientist.

"As for the prisoner, it's only fair we show you this. Flintecca had information on our prisoner, just like she had with your guest. Shadow Weaver" Gareth snarled, holding the prisoner by the scruff of his neck. Catra chuckled cruelly and gently gripped the bag around the prisoner's head. "Behold, the greatest secret Hordak ever had." Catra yanked the bag off the prisoner.

Adora's eyes widened to the size of moons, her sword fell to the ground. She was looking at Glimmer's father, Angella's Husband… Kreia's grandfather. King Micah of Brightmoon. His long black locks of hair and a messy beard helped accent his face, but aside from this? It was very clear that they had been taking great care of him. "D-don't hurt-" Adora was interrupted by Gareth's expression softening a bit. "You want him huh? Well we'll trade you him for

Weaver. But not now, go enjoy your victory with Calderon and Flintecca hm?" Gareth holstered his shotgun and activated a commlink. "Entrapta, 7 to beam up".

Adora grabbed her sword only for the Ziadrothans, her siblings and Micah to vanish in a flash of light. They had teleported onto the Muninn which began to take off, Adora ran as fast as she could across the hangar towards the ship. But the ship had already taken off and was soaring across the sky and within a few minutes it was gone, she looked outwards from the hangar, seeing the vast lands unfurl before her, she looked down to see the burnt forest that she had landed in when this quest began. From it she could, with her She-Ra senses, see the Landboat that Catra and her delegation arrived in, riding off into the horizon. Adora clenched her fists and sighed, she returned to her normal form and re-entered Calderon. She saw that the short lived civil war, if one could call it that, was easily stamped out. Adora approached Frosta and Flintecca, she tried to not throw a punch at the fire princess.

"You knew they had Micah." Adora glared at Flintecca. This prompted shocked expressions from Frosta and Swift Wind. Flintecca was about to talk but Adora held up her hand "It doesn't matter now. I'll talk to Glimmer about it, but for now…welcome to the Coalition." she walked past Flintecca "now let's give this volcano a wake up call." On board the Muninn, despite a failure of Diplomacy, there was a very cheerful mood on board. "Hehehe! Oh Adora's shocked expression will be forever something to remember! I'm definitely going to do some laser engravings to remember it by" Entrapta said with a giggle, spinning in her pilot's chair.

The ship's AI hummed and said "of course, Imperial Scientist Entrapta, I have captured Adora's shocked expression in various High Quality resolutions." the AI spoke and Entrapta nodded, grabbing a fresh cup of recaff with one of her hair tendrils. "Excellent work Darla, I appreciate it" Entrapta thanked the loyal AI for its work. Gareth sat in the Captain's throne, his godstone glowing intensely, and his veins glowing Gold. Regardless of this, he remained himself and in good spirits. "Once we manage to get Darla off this reliance for either the Sword of Protection or the Godstone the better." Gareth said, resting his head on his knuckles. Elsewhere on board the ship were the sounds of partying, the various ranks and grunts of Ziadroth, along with their new Calderonian passengers, were having a fun time.

The First Ones tech they seized would help them greatly, but it was mainly a strategy of resource denial. Simply grab it before they do…though it would have been nice to have control over Calderon. Perhaps another time. Catra walked up to Gareth and gave him a big kiss on the cheek, purring all the way, she then laid across his lap, looking up into his eyes.

"In the mood for a surprise?" Catra purred happily, Gareth looked at her with a raised eyebrow and a flirty smile. "Oh? Like what?" Catra cupped his cheeks and brought him close to her face. "I'm pregnant, you're gonna be a father, Gare-Bear"

Gareth's happiness went fucking ballistic.

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